

Zachary E. Sparkman

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SUMMARY

Monetization strategist and product builder with 10+ years driving revenue across streaming, CTV, and linear TV platforms. Proven track record architecting yield optimization strategies, pricing frameworks, and cross-platform inventory systems for **\$190MM in combined annual ad revenue** across premium live sports properties. Manages a two-person yield team across LA and Dallas markets, with cross-functional leadership across Sales, Ad Ops, Engineering, and Product. Independently designs and ships web-based data products that solve real business problems, from internal sales tools to public-facing advertising intelligence platforms. Domain expertise in FreeWheel, programmatic activation, addressable advertising, FCC compliance, and live sports ad monetization.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Manager, Yield & Inventory | RSNs & National Multi-Market

Spectrum Reach | March 2025 – Present

- Own end-to-end yield strategy, pricing, and inventory management across **\$190MM in combined annual ad revenue** spanning Lakers & Dodgers RSNs, LA & Dallas Interconnects (streaming, CTV, and linear), leading a two-person yield team across LA and Dallas markets
- Define rate card frameworks, dynamic floor pricing, and yield optimization rules across FreeWheel and Wide Orbit, partnering with Ad Ops, Engineering, and national sales leadership to set KPIs (fill rate, sell-through, eCPM, makegood liability) and prioritize inventory initiatives across programmatic CTV and linear scheduling
- Shipped the Live Sports CTV Package Builder, an internal sales tool used by 50+ reps across 10+ properties that automates streaming ad package configuration and proposal generation, eliminating a lengthy manual process (see Product Portfolio)
- Manage FCC political broadcasting compliance across **\$34MM+ in on-cycle political revenue**, including LUR thresholds, equal access obligations, and inventory allocation across federal and state election windows

Pricing and Planning Manager | Spectrum SportsNet & SportsNet LA

Spectrum Reach | January 2020 – February 2025

- Architected pricing and inventory segmentation strategy for live sports streaming and CTV ad pods in partnership with Sales, Ad Ops, and Product, delivering **+74% CPM growth in premium live in-game inventory** while pioneering addressable, programmatic, and DAI activation across connected devices
- Operated as deal desk for Sales, reviewing and approving proposals, clearing inventory with Ad Ops as primary Sales/Ops liaison
- Designed and shipped a multi-property analytics and inventory platform for both RSNs, built on a 10-view product framework over a Power Query data pipeline used daily by yield, sales, and revenue assurance to manage **\$57MM in annual ad revenue**
- Built bottom-up RSN revenue planning model that replaced flat top-down budget targets with a unit-economics framework, deriving revenue capacity from game count, inventory volume per game, impression delivery, ratings, and monetized CPM; informs annual budget and forecast cycles for both RSNs

Senior Account Manager | Agency Sales

Nexstar Media Group | February 2017 – January 2020

- Identified a gap in Fox NFL ad packaging, redesigned the DMA-level pricing and inventory bundling strategy, and launched a revised package that delivered **+78% growth in average order value**
- Managed a 100+ account portfolio spanning national brands (Nissan, Mercedes-Benz, Ford, Subway, McDonald's) and agency relationships with Initiative, OMD, Carat, and Litha/Media Access Group, developing integrated cross-platform proposals across digital, OTT, and linear inventory
- Built pricing strategy frameworks for premium sports and local programming inventory, establishing rate card structures and sell-through optimization practices that informed early programmatic and CTV monetization strategies

Digital Account Executive | New Business Development

Coastal Television Broadcasting Company | July 2015 – February 2017

- Launched the station group's first digital advertising division from the ground up — defined go-to-market strategy, built pricing models, and established sales operations across 3 DMAs, functioning as a 0-to-1 product owner for a new revenue line
- Generated **\$200K+ in new digital revenue within 6 months** by pioneering video pre-roll and display ad monetization on station O&O properties alongside SEM, SEO, and social media services
- Partnered with linear sales teams across 5 broadcast stations to develop integrated cross-platform advertising solutions, bridging \$7MM in traditional spot business with emerging digital inventory, an early cross-platform monetization model

PRODUCT PORTFOLIO

Live Sports CTV Package Platform | CTV-Builder.ZachSparkman.com

Sales enablement product for streaming ad packages | Solo Build @ Spectrum Reach

- Designed and built a web app that calculates streaming ad packages for live sports, enabling 50+ reps across 10+ properties to configure rate-class, DMA, flight dates, and budgets to create branded proposal decks
- Architecture: Next.js single-page app with embedded PPTX template engine, dynamic xlsx data ingestion, client-side PPTX generation via JSZip & SharePoint REST API sync for centralized asset distribution
- Features include a multi-property package builder with real-time CPM calculation, rate-class toggling, max-imps enforcement against live inventory caps, embedded base64 master template for branded PPTX deck generation, bulk template upload via the browser File System Access API, and one-click export to .pptx

Political Window | PoliticalWindow.com

Political advertising intelligence platform | Sole Founder & Developer

- Designed and built a full-stack web application that parses FCC public file PDFs into structured data, enabling political media buyers to identify LUR violations, track candidate ad spend, and navigate FCC compliance windows across all 210 U.S. DMAs
- Architecture: Neon PostgreSQL → Express/Node.js API (Railway) → JavaScript frontend (GitHub Pages) with Claude Sonnet-powered PDF extraction pipeline, JWT/bcrypt authentication, and FEC + FollowTheMoney API integrations
- Features include a 50-state interactive election map with FCC window countdowns, an FCC rate explorer, LUR violation detection engine (the platform's core strategic differentiator), and a multi-source candidate ad spend tracker

RSN Yield Platform | RSN-Yield.ZachSparkman.com

Inventory & yield management platform for RSNs | Solo Build @ Spectrum Reach

- Designed and built a Next.js web application that consolidates booked spots, schedules, and inventory data into a unified decision-support layer used daily by yield, sales, and revenue assurance teams to manage allocation across \$57MM in annual ad revenue for the Lakers and Dodgers RSNs
- Architecture: Next.js single-page application with a server-driven data layer feeding a six-view product framework — Inventory, Rates, Heatmap, Booking Matrix, Yield Summary, and About — covering every angle of yield decisioning from per-game capacity to portfolio-level revenue decomposition
- Features include a per-game inventory view with capacity, avails, sellout, and net revenue by date, matchup, and inventory type; a weekly rate card of open avails and dynamic rates; a per-game sellout heatmap; a client x date booking matrix of EQ30 by spot status; and a LOB-group yield summary with EUR (Net), AUR, and sellout per game

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Business Administration, Accounting

University of Alaska Anchorage, December 2018

Digital Media Sales Certification

Interactive Advertising Bureau (IAB), March 2023

SKILLS & TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

- **Ad Tech & Platforms:** FreeWheel MRM, Wide Orbit (Traffic & Media Sales), Google Ad Manager, Operative AOS, programmatic SSP/DSP ecosystems, Hudson MX
- **Data & Analytics:** SQL, PowerBI, ComScore, Nielsen, Salesforce; experienced building analytical dashboards and yield reporting pipelines
- **Technical / Product Building:** PostgreSQL, Node.js, REST API design, Git/GitHub, Railway, AWS S3/CloudFront, SharePoint API
- **AI Development Tools:** Claude (API, Claude Code, claude.ai), OpenAI (Codex, ChatGPT), LM Studio for local LLM inference, LangChain for agent workflows, Apple Vision (pyobjc) for on-device OCR; integrate AI into production data pipelines and ship features end-to-end with AI-assisted development
- **Domain Expertise:** CTV/OTT ad monetization, live sports inventory strategy, ad pod optimization, addressable advertising, FCC regulatory compliance, cross-platform yield management, programmatic supply-side strategy, inventory governance & rate card design, revenue planning & unit-economics modeling
- **Languages:** Fluent in Spanish with full professional proficiency